

anything unfortunate happens to the actual documents, you might save a lot of time, hassle, and money by having that information readily available.

11. Do it yourself

This can apply to making gear, doing laundry in the shower, booking your own reservations, cooking on the fly, taking loads of photos as your alternative souvenir collection, and more. It also applies to things you can do before and after your trip to save money for travel on a regular basis.

12. Carve out the cash

This is possible in all areas of travel. Some ideas will be more appealing to you, others not so much. But the fact is, money *can* be saved, and independent long-term travel is far more affordable than most people think. In fact, we found we spent less money on the road having a blast than we did living outside of Tucson and clipping coupons. Pack a brown-bag type of picnic, incorporate a

few hammock-sleeping campground evenings, or BYO sleep-sack hostels along the way in between the other guesthouse or B&B stops. Just bring along a travel padlock or two for standard travel security issues.

13. Slow down

Seriously, just slow down. Just like letting off your car's accelerator can save you gasoline, slowing down the pace on your trip can help pinch more than pennies. With travel as in business, time is money.

14. Location, location, location

This applies to more than just business. Certain regions are far more affordable than others. If you are just starting to explore travel as a hobby or life passion, do you have to see Europe first? I love it there too, but South America or Southeast Asia is way more affordable. Ditto with Indonesia versus Japan.

15. Bond with your car

Or if possible, a camper van. Many people try this as an alternative to RV trips. If you want to take the whole "fam damnily," the RV plan is certainly more affordable than high-end hotels, particularly for the long term.

